

INDO-PACIFIC, INDIAN OCEAN AND MARITIME SECURITY

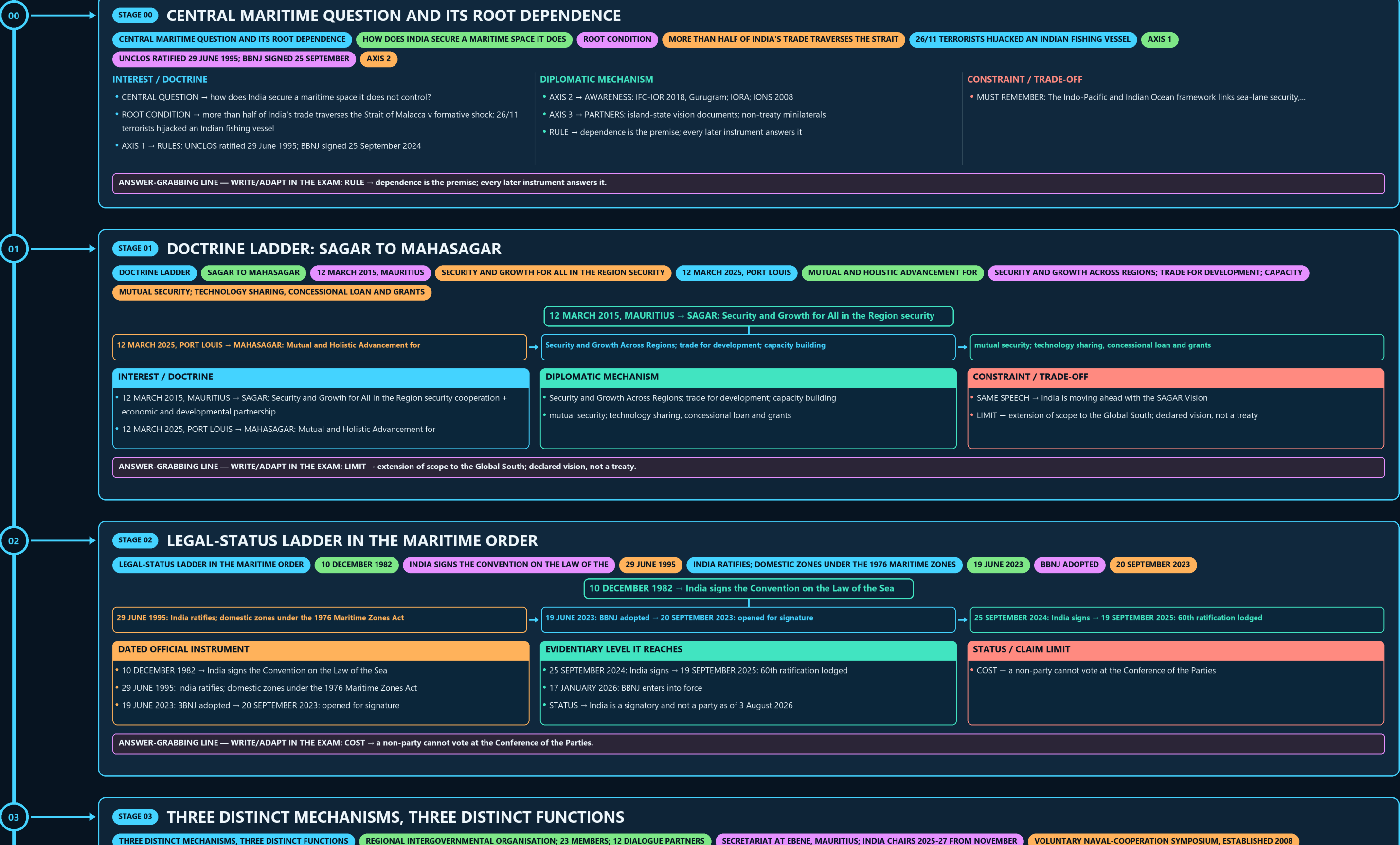
CENTRAL MARITIME QUESTION AND → DOCTRINE LADDER: SAGAR TO → LEGAL-STATUS LADDER IN THE → THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE → INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS → MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COST → a non-party cannot vote at the Conference of the Parties.

03

STAGE 03 THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE DISTINCT FUNCTIONS

THREE DISTINCT MECHANISMS, THREE DISTINCT FUNCTIONS REGIONAL INTERGOVERNMENTAL ORGANISATION; 23 MEMBERS; 12 DIALOGUE PARTNERS SECRETARIAT AT EBENE, MAURITIUS; INDIA CHAIRS 2025-27 FROM NOVEMBER VOLUNTARY NAVAL-COOPERATION SYMPOSIUM, ESTABLISHED 2008
INDIA ASSUMED THE CHAIR ON 20 FEBRUARY 2026 INDIAN NAVY INFORMATION-FUSION CENTRE, 2018, GURUGRAM; NOVEMBER 2025 25 PARTNER COUNTRIES AND INTERNATIONAL LIAISON OFFICERS FROM 15 THREE SEPARATE BODIES, NEVER INTERCHANGEABLE NAMES FOR ONE MECHANISM

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
IORA → regional intergovernmental organisation; 23 members; 12 dialogue partners	India assumed the chair on 20 February 2026	TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism
Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025-27 from November 2025	IFC-IOR → Indian Navy information-fusion centre, 2018, Gurugram; November 2025	LIMIT → a chairship is agenda-setting and convening power, not control
IONS → voluntary naval-cooperation symposium, established 2008	25 partner countries and International Liaison Officers from 15 countries	
ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
- IORA → regional intergovernmental organisation; 23 members; 12 dialogue partners - Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025-27 from November 2025 - IONS → voluntary naval-cooperation symposium, established 2008	- India assumed the chair on 20 February 2026 - IFC-IOR → Indian Navy information-fusion centre, 2018, Gurugram; November 2025 25 partner countries and International Liaison Officers from 15 countries	- TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism - LIMIT → a chairship is agenda-setting and convening power, not control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism.

04

STAGE 04 INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS

INDIA'S OWN CAPABILITY INSTRUMENTS FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND PORT BLAIR, CITED AS A REGIONAL ENGAGEMENT INSTRUMENT BIENNIAL NAVAL-FLEET GATHERING RUNNING SINCE 1995 MULTILATERAL ANTI-PIRACY COOPERATION INDIA ACTIVELY PARTICIPATES IN SAGAR PRAHARI BAL
INDIAN NAVY FORCE RAISED IN 2009 FOR BASE AND OPERATIONS ROUTE TO THE INTERNAL SECURITY MARITIME AND COASTAL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument	ReCAAP → multilateral anti-piracy cooperation India actively participates in	BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner
MILAN → biennial naval-fleet gathering running since 1995	SAGAR PRAHARI BAL → Indian Navy force raised in 2009 for base and vulnerable-point protection	FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument
ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
- FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument - MILAN → biennial naval-fleet gathering running since 1995	- ReCAAP → multilateral anti-piracy cooperation India actively participates in - SAGAR PRAHARI BAL → Indian Navy force raised in 2009 for base and vulnerable-point protection	- BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner - FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND → Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner.

05

STAGE 05 MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT BY COMPONENT

MALDIVES INSTRUMENT PRICED COMPONENT BY COMPONENT 7 OCTOBER 2024 INDIA-MALDIVES JOINT VISION FOR COMPREHENSIVE ECONOMIC AND MARITIME SECURITY PARTNERSHIP USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION CURRENCY-SWAP ARRANGEMENT
ARRANGED FACILITY, NOT EVIDENCE OF DRAWDOWN 25 JULY 2025

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
7 OCTOBER 2024 → India-Maldives Joint Vision for Comprehensive Economic and	LEVEL: arranged facility, not evidence of drawdown	LEVEL → Terms of Reference launch talks; they do not conclude an agreement
Maritime Security Partnership	25 JULY 2025 → FTA Terms of Reference signed and negotiations launched	READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer
USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION → currency-swap arrangement	INR 4,850 crore Line of Credit	
ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
7 OCTOBER 2024 → India-Maldives Joint Vision for Comprehensive Economic and - Maritime Security Partnership - USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION → currency-swap arrangement	- LEVEL: arranged facility, not evidence of drawdown 25 JULY 2025 → FTA Terms of Reference signed and negotiations launched - INR 4,850 crore Line of Credit	- LEVEL → Terms of Reference launch talks; they do not conclude an agreement - READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer.

06

STAGE 06 COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX

COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING SRI LANKA 9 FEBRUARY 2026 INDIA WELCOMED SEYCHELLES' DECISION TO BECOME A FULL MEMBER NO OFFICIALLY RECORDED EFFECTIVE ACCESSION DATE
MEMBER, OBSERVER, GUEST AND DECIDED TO JOIN ARE FOUR

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer.

06

STAGE 06 COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX

COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE CATEGORY MATRIX

STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING

SRI LANKA

9 FEBRUARY 2026

INDIA WELCOMED SEYCHELLES' DECISION TO BECOME A FULL MEMBER

NO OFFICIALLY RECORDED EFFECTIVE ACCESSION DATE

MEMBER, OBSERVER, GUEST AND DECIDED TO JOIN ARE FOUR

OBSERVER	Seychelles
GUEST	Malaysia

ACTOR / INTEREST

- STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING
- Sri Lanka

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- 9 FEBRUARY 2026 → India welcomed Seychelles' decision to become a full member
- MISSING → no officially recorded effective accession date

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- TRAP → member, observer, guest and decided to join are four separate claims
- STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → member, observer, guest and decided to join are four separate claims.

07

STAGE 07 INDO-PACIFIC ARCHITECTURE AND ITS SEVEN PILLARS

INDO-PACIFIC ARCHITECTURE AND ITS SEVEN PILLARS

4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14TH EAST ASIA SUMMIT

INDO-PACIFIC OCEANS INITIATIVE

MARITIME SECURITY

MARITIME ECOLOGY

MARITIME RESOURCES CAPACITY BUILDING AND RESOURCE SHARING

DISASTER-RISK REDUCTION AND MANAGEMENT SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND ACADEMIC COOPERATION

TRADE, CONNECTIVITY, MARITIME TRANSPORT

4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14th EAST ASIA SUMMIT → Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative

PILLARS → maritime security

maritime ecology

maritime resources capacity building and resource sharing

disaster-risk reduction and management science, technology and academic cooperation

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14th EAST ASIA SUMMIT → Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative
- PILLARS → maritime security
- maritime ecology

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- maritime resources capacity building and resource sharing
- disaster-risk reduction and management science, technology and academic cooperation
- trade, connectivity, maritime transport

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- ASEAN CENTRALITY → the Initiative and the ASEAN Outlook are complementary
- FORUMS → East Asia Summit is leaders-led; ASEAN Regional Forum builds confidence
- LIMIT → not a treaty, alliance or centralised funding body; weak enforcement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not a treaty, alliance or centralised funding body; weak enforcement.

08

STAGE 08 MINILATERAL CAPABILITY AGAINST STRUCTURAL ASYMMETRY

MINILATERAL CAPABILITY AGAINST STRUCTURAL ASYMMETRY

INDIA-US EXERCISE; JAPAN ADDED; REGULAR AUSTRALIAN PARTICIPATION FROM 2020

INTEROPERABILITY AMONG ALL FOUR QUADRILATERAL STATES

DOES NOT PROVE

ANY COLLECTIVE-DEFENCE OBLIGATION

THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY

WASHINGTON HOLDS LONG-ESTABLISHED TREATY RELATIONSHIPS THAT OTHER MEMBERS, INDIA

THE GROUPING SUPPLEMENTS INDIAN CAPACITY; IT NEVER SUBSTITUTES FOR

ACTOR / INTEREST

MALABAR → India-US exercise; Japan added; regular Australian participation from 2020

PROVES: interoperability among all four Quadrilateral states

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

DOES NOT PROVE: any collective-defence obligation

THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY → Washington holds long-established treaty relationships that other members, India included, do not share among themselves

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

CONSEQUENCE → the grouping supplements Indian capacity; it never substitutes for it

OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10

ACTOR / INTEREST

- MALABAR → India-US exercise; Japan added; regular Australian participation from 2020
- PROVES: interoperability among all four Quadrilateral states

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DOES NOT PROVE: any collective-defence obligation
- THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY → Washington holds long-established treaty relationships that other members, India included, do not share among themselves

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → the grouping supplements Indian capacity; it never substitutes for it
- OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OWNERSHIP → the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10.

09

STAGE 09 AUKUS PATHWAY AND ITS OPEN QUESTIONS

AUKUS PATHWAY AND ITS OPEN QUESTIONS

15 SEPTEMBER 2021

AUKUS ANNOUNCED BY AUSTRALIA, THE UK AND THE UNITED

TRACK 1

CONVENTIONALLY ARMED, NUCLEAR-POWERED SUBMARINES FOR AUSTRALIA

TRACK 2

CYBER, ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, QUANTUM, FURTHER UNDERSEA CAPABILITIES

MARCH 2023 PATHWAY

15 SEPTEMBER 2021 → AUKUS announced by Australia, the UK and the United States

TRACK 1 → conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarines for Australia

TRACK 2 → cyber, artificial intelligence, quantum, further undersea capabilities

MARCH 2023 PATHWAY → rotational UK-US presence from as early as 2027

Virginia-class sale from the early 2030s subject to US approval; later SSN-AUKUS

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

STAGE 09

AUKUS PATHWAY AND ITS OPEN QUESTIONS

15 SEPTEMBER 2021

AUKUS ANNOUNCED BY AUSTRALIA, THE UK AND THE UNITED STATES

TRACK 1

CONVENTIONALLY ARMED, NUCLEAR-POWERED SUBMARINES FOR AUSTRALIA

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INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 15 SEPTEMBER 2021 → AUKUS announced by Australia, the UK and the United States
- TRACK 1 → conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarines for Australia
- TRACK 2 → cyber, artificial intelligence, quantum, further undersea capabilities

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- MARCH 2023 PATHWAY → rotational UK-US presence from as early as 2027
- Virginia-class sale from the early 2030s subject to US approval; later SSN-AUKUS
- JUNE 2022 → EUR 555 million settlement over the cancelled French programme

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- NOVEMBER 2025 → IAEA Article 14 safeguards arrangement still under negotiation
- INDIA → not an AUKUS member; its Quadrilateral route is parallel and non-treaty
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: UNCLOS membership is not acceptance of every maritime claim, freedom...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: UNCLOS membership is not acceptance of every maritime claim, freedom.

STAGE 10

SECTORAL RULE-MAKING AT THE INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION

1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED

1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE

UN SPECIALISED AGENCY

ASSEMBLY (ALL MEMBERS)

COUNCIL (EXECUTIVE)

MSC, MEPC, LEGAL, TC, FAL

BALLAST WATER MANAGEMENT, IN FORCE 2017

1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED → 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE → UN specialised agency

ORGANS → Assembly (all members)

Council (executive)

MSC, MEPC, Legal, TC, FAL

INSTRUMENTS → SOLAS

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- 1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED → 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE → UN specialised agency
- ORGANS → Assembly (all members)
- Council (executive)
- MSC, MEPC, Legal, TC, FAL

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- INSTRUMENTS → SOLAS
- Ballast Water Management, in force 2017
- Hong Kong ship recycling, in force 26 June 2025
- 1 JANUARY 2020 → global sulphur limit cut from 3.50% to 0.50% m/m

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- 2023 GHG STRATEGY → net zero by or around 2050, with 2030 and 2040 checkpoints
- OCTOBER 2025 → Net-Zero Framework approved at committee level, NOT adopted; adjourned
- INDIA → elected to Council Category (b) for 2026-27; access, not guaranteed outcomes
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Verify grouping membership, exercise...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Verify grouping membership, exercise.

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE FOR A MARITIME DEMAND

NAME THE SEA-LANE DEPENDENCE AND THE EXACT INTEREST IT

RULES, AWARENESS AND PARTNERS, EACH WITH ONE DATED INSTRUMENT

PRICE EXTERNAL-POWER BASING, ISLAND-STATE AGENCY AND MINILATERAL ASYMMETRY

QUALIFY THE NET SECURITY PROVIDER LABEL AND GIVE A

OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates

BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

TEST → price external-power basing, island-state agency and minilateral asymmetry

CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates
- BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- TEST → price external-power basing, island-state agency and minilateral asymmetry
- CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- OPEN → name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates
- BUILD → rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE PRINCIPAL REGIONAL POLITICAL FORUM FOR LITTORAL-STATE

IONS (2008)

VOLUNTARY NAVAL-COOPERATION SYMPOSIUM AMONG INDIAN OCEAN

IFC-IOR (2018, GURUGRAM)

THE OPERATIONAL INFORMATION-SHARING LAYER FOR

SAGAR PRAHARI BAL (2009)

A SPECIALISED INDIAN NAVY FORCE FOR BASE AND

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH

- IORA: the principal regional political forum for littoral-state
- IONS (2008): voluntary naval-cooperation symposium among Indian Ocean
- IFC-IOR (2018, Gurugram): the operational information-sharing layer for
- Sagar Prahari Bal (2009): a specialised Indian Navy force for base and

STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT

- India-Maldives Vision for Comprehensive Economic and Maritime Security
- CAUTION: Quad's maritime-security dimension: a non-treaty, asymmetric coalition
- CAUTION: Colombo Security Conclave: a regional maritime and security-cooperation
- CAUTION: Route Internal Security (naval/anti-piracy operations) to

COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE

- Direct PYQ boundary case (2024 Q20): the question explicitly asks about
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Maldives' own hedging: consistent with island-state
- CAUTION: Boundary case — chairship without control: India simultaneously chairs
- CAUTION: Boundary case — Quad asymmetry: Tharoor's point about unequal treaty

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.